



Individual Instructor Report Fall 2022 Version A for STA 301 - INTRODUCTION TO DATA SCIENCE (05230) (Henrique Bolfarine)

Project Title: **Instructor Course Evaluations Fall 2022**

Courses Audience: **60**

Responses Received: **28**

Response Ratio: **46.7%**

Report Comments

Results were produced during the Fall 2022 implementation of new course evaluation questions and systems. Courses with final exams conducted on December 8th, 2022, may have overlapped with the evaluation window.

Guide to the Interpretation of Course Evaluations at UT Austin

The goal of course evaluation process at UT Austin is to drive teaching excellence and to support continuous improvement in teaching and learning experiences. The two sets of scales used for core evaluation questions and the associated weights are:

Strongly Agree (5)
Agree (4)
Neutral (3)
Disagree (2)
Strongly Disagree (1)

Excellent (5)
Very Good (4)
Satisfactory (3)
Unsatisfactory (2)
Very Unsatisfactory (1)

The Mean is calculated by adding all of the weights for a single question and dividing by the number of respondents. The course workload question is not averaged.

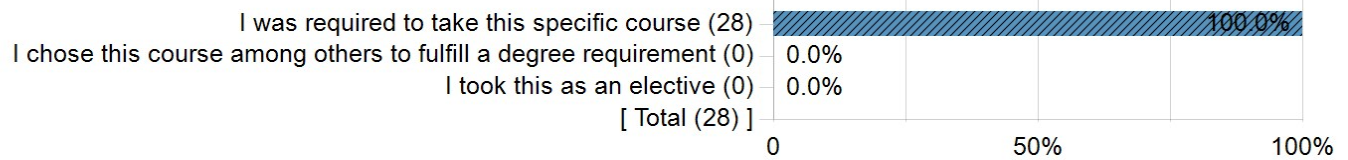
The number of students (e.g. Respondents) marking each option is reported for each of the items. These frequency distributions provide information about the level of student ratings and the spread and shape of the class distribution of responses. The distributions thus provide a picture of student perception of a course.

Course evaluations provide snapshots of student perspectives on their course-level learning experiences. Most experts on teaching evaluation advise that no one method gives the complete picture of an instructor's teaching effectiveness; multiple and diverse measures, on multiple occasions, are advised to give a full picture of the teaching effectiveness of a particular instructor. Moreover, other factors, such as size of class, level of the class, and content of the course, can cause small variations in the ratings. Therefore, student perspectives for a particular instructor or course should be interpreted as a snapshot, and not as providing complete information on the teaching effectiveness of that instructor.

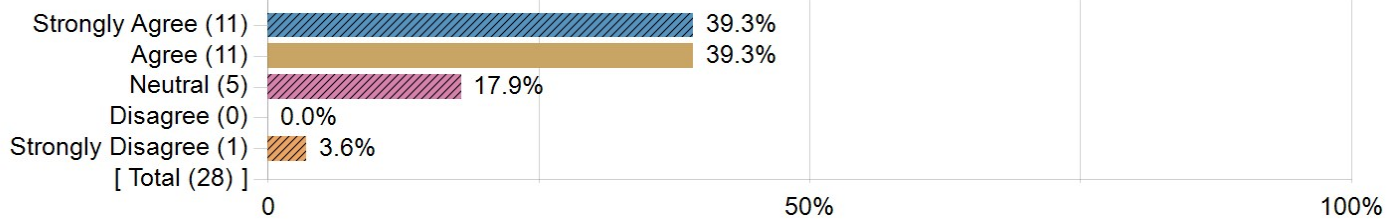
Creation Date: **Friday, May 5, 2023**

Course Questions

Why did you take this course?



During this course, I gained a deeper understanding of the subject matter.



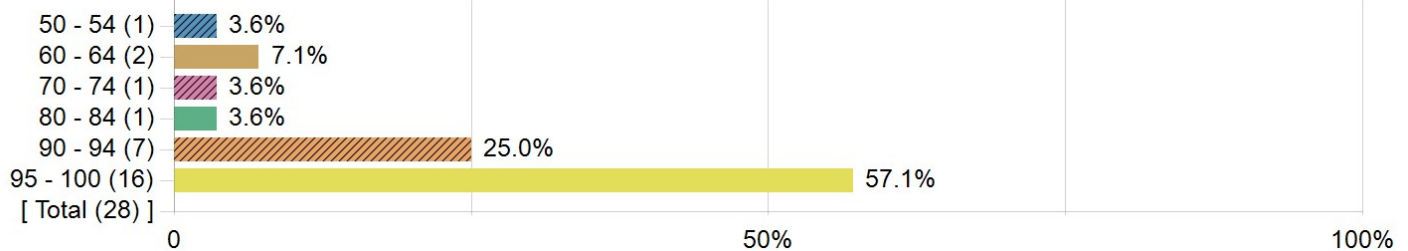
Statistics

Value

Mean

4.11

Overall, approximately what percentage of the course meetings did you attend or complete (online, in person, or asynchronously)?



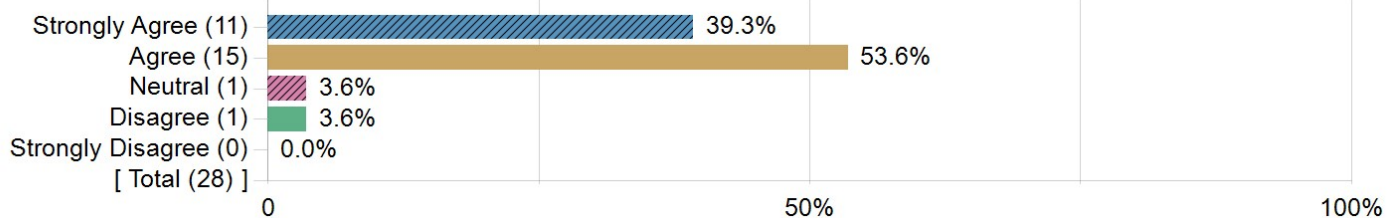
Statistics

Value

Mean

90.68

The course assignments improved my ability to apply logical, numerical, or statistical skills to real-world problems.



Statistics

Value

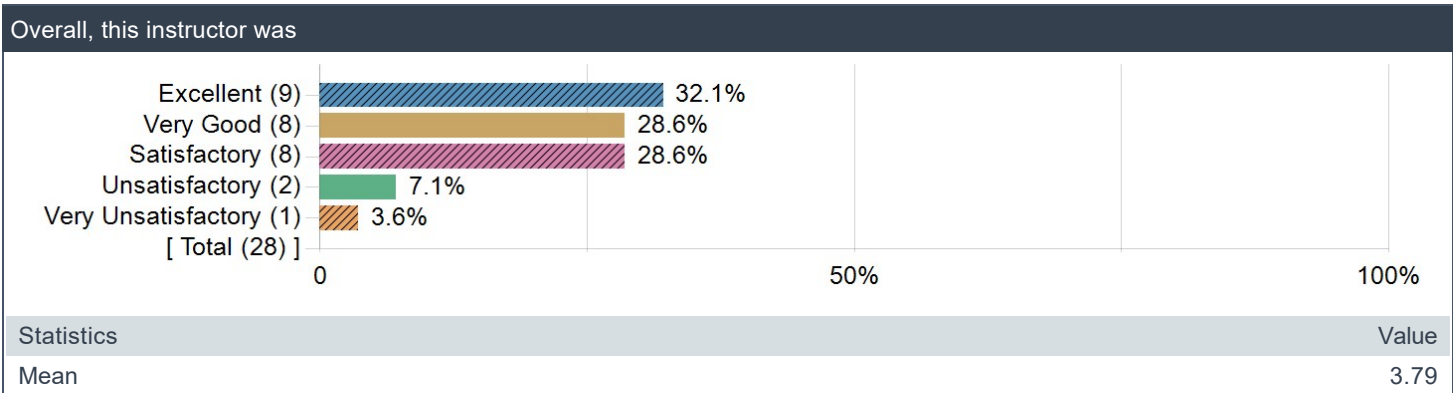
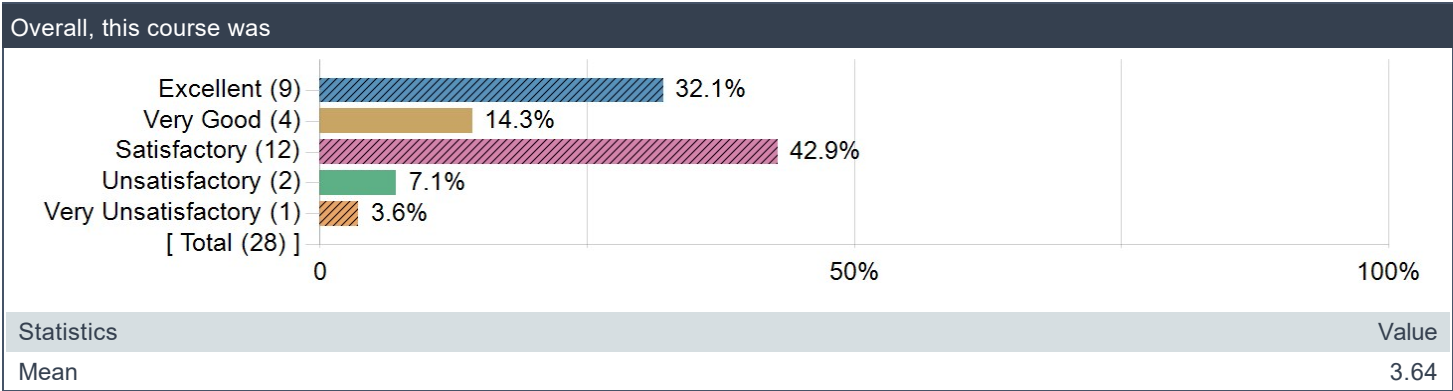
Mean

4.29

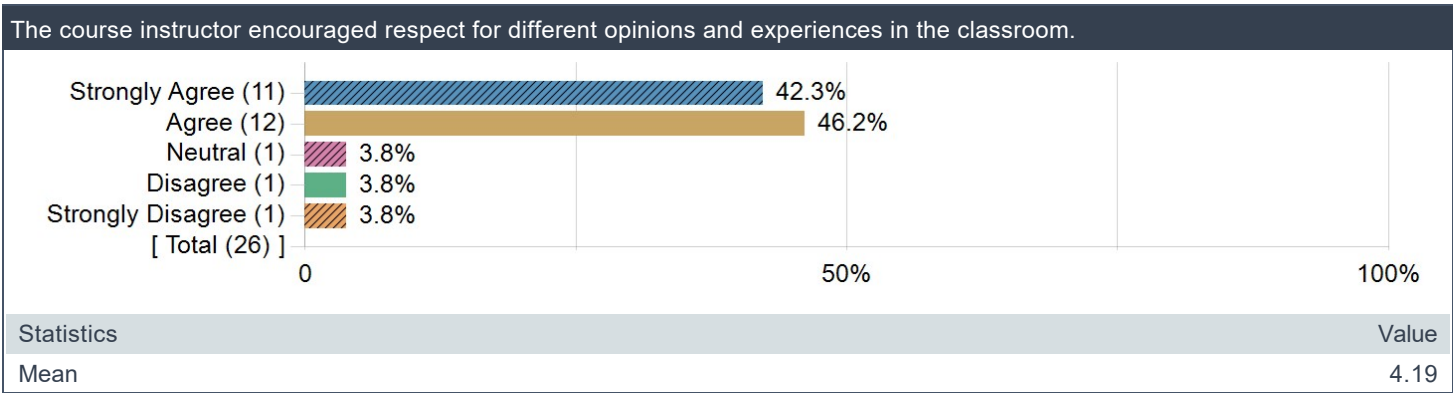
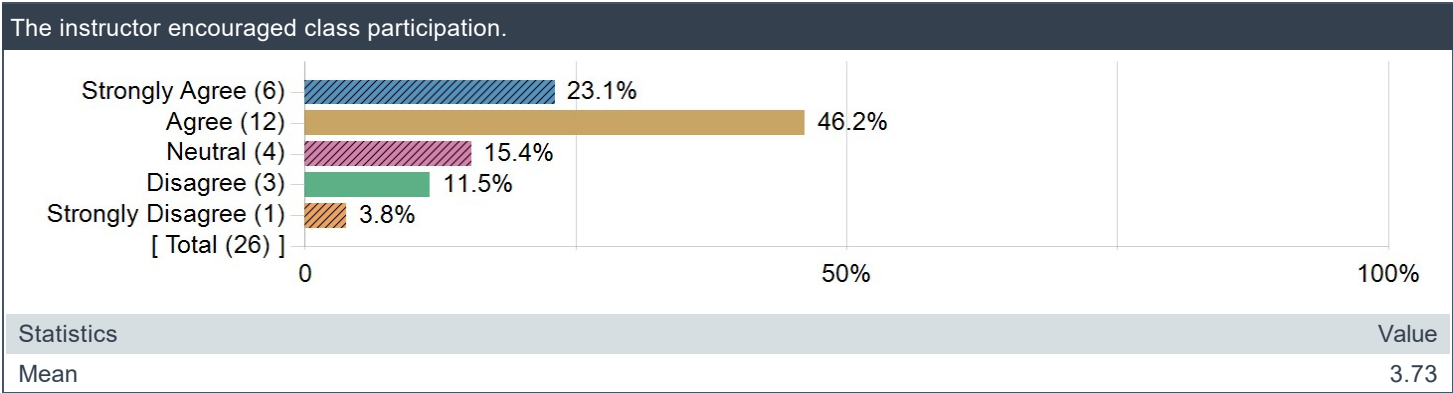
Instructor Questions

	Strongly Agree	Agree	Neutral	Disagree	Strongly Disagree	Responded	Mean
The instructor clearly explained the course objectives and expectations.	35.7%	42.9%	7.1%	14.3%	0.0%	28	4.00
The instructor fostered an inclusive learning environment.	42.9%	28.6%	25.0%	0.0%	3.6%	28	4.07
The instructor effectively explained the concepts and subject matter in this course.	25.0%	39.3%	21.4%	10.7%	3.6%	28	3.71
The instructional techniques kept me engaged in learning.	25.0%	35.7%	10.7%	17.9%	10.7%	28	3.46
The instructor checked for student understanding of the concepts presented in the course.	39.3%	28.6%	25.0%	3.6%	3.6%	28	3.96

Overall Questions



College, School, or Unit Questions



Comment Questions

Identify aspects of the course that were the most effective in helping your learning.

Comments
–extra help sessions when learning how to use R Studio
Professor Bolfarine did a great job helping me understand the concepts that we required to comprehend.
Very inclusive learning environment
The most effective aspects of the course were the homework's and knowledge checks. These kept me on track and neatly organized the agenda for the week. I also appreciated Dr. Bolfarine's helpful reminders for each week assignments. The TA's were also very helpful and understanding of the struggle.
The textbook examples were very helpful. However, in class, I felt we did a majority of conceptual learning rather than coding, and I hope in the future more coding in class can be incorporated.
The repetition of the concepts to get us to learn it was truly appreciated! The weekly knowledge checks along with having unlimited attempts to get us to learn the subject was super helpful as well. The office hours held with this professor were also super helpful. What I really appreciate about Dr. Bolfarine is that he truly cares about us, his students, to the point where he will work with us to understand the topics even if it takes up his time. It is very apparent that he wants us to succeed.
Helped visualize certain situations, rather than just lecturing.
Lectures & r–studio practice
The office hours for this course were very helpful
The textbook was helpful
Having knowledge checks after each of the classes was effective in applying the material from the class to problems and having an idea of what to expect on future problems.
Dr. Bolfarine engaged the class by asking questions constantly.
Reading the textbook and doing R code problems in class.
instapolls
r sessions and groupme with TA's
The knowledge checks.

Identify the aspect of the course that you found most challenging, why you found it was challenging, and suggest one thing that could be done to help future students meet that challenge more effectively.

Comments
–learning R Studio because it was brand new to me –attend help sessions and watch videos posted online
The most challenging part of this course was coding. It was difficult because in order to code successfully one had to be 100% sure of what they were doing rather than having the ability to make an educated guess.
the knowledge checks
I think the most challenging aspect of the course is remembering and seeing all possible questions and scenarios. I would suggest creating an optional weekly knowledge check that would help understand the most obscure scenarios and problems that tend to find their ways on tests.
This course was very challenging because I had to learn to code for the first time, and because it moves at such a fast pace. It is very hard to grasp every topic and chapter due to the pace of this class. Breaking up the fundamental concepts, especially in the later half of the semester, would be helpful.
I personally think the timing during the exams could be heavily improved. However, I don't blame Dr. Bolfarine seeing as he doesn't have control of this matter. I just think coding at such high speed and answering difficult questions could be improved for the sake of our academic health. I also think the overall speed of the class was quite fast and at times overwhelming because of it.
Learning the curriculum.
Practicing the problems on my own and finding a group to study for knowledge checks
The tests were challenging and did not give enough time
It was not explained too well
I found it challenging to understand some of the course material because the professor focused more on conceptual ideas and powerpoint slides than applying the material in R. In order to help future students more effectively, Professor Bolfarine needs to provide examples in R that are universal and can be applied to future problems.
At times I left the course with questions because the concepts weren't talked about clearly in class.
It can seem like a lot of information at first, but just keep up with textbook readings and start homeworks early.
quiz
Dr. Bolfarine was not good at explaining and attending the lectures were mostly useless because he would not cover what was on the homework and exams.
the professor just read off the slides with little to no explanation to further deepen my understanding. His accent/language barrier also made it harder for him to explain very well.
The teaching in class was not over coding.
Instructor was not engaging